

How we Test



In Test this Month

A new year and a whole new set of technologies on the horizon! In this New Year's issue, we bring you some of the hottest technologies and products over a range of categories. In our comparison tests, we have a shootout between 10 laser printers in the sub-Rs 30,000 category from six different brands. If you've always wanted to buy a laser printer but were under the impression that it would cost a lot, this is the shootout that will help you with your decision.



We have also reviewed a cross section of some of the funkiest input devices comprising of six keyboards, 10 mice and four keyboard-mouse combinations featuring some of the newest technologies like dual optical sensors, wireless connectivity and even unifications of the two! Be it gaming, image editing or even general use, find the keyboard and mouse that suits you best.

In the Bazaar section, we bring you reviews of the hottest products such as Intel's newest Pentium 4 3.06 GHz with HyperThreading technology. There are also a set of digital droolables here, with the funky and feature rich Fuji S602 Zoom digital camera and the lightweight and incredibly portable Creative MuVo portable MP3 player. Don't forget to check out peripherals such as the Canon Canoscan LiDE 20 scanner and Iomega's newest 48x24x48x external USB 2.0 CD-Writer.

It looks good and the technology is glitzy, but does it do the job?

The Digital Media Test & Research Centre (DMTRC) conducts a series of elaborate tests to evaluate the merit of each hardware and software product. To ensure that our readers have all the information they need to make an informed buying decision, engineers at DMTRC evaluate and review the latest hardware, software and technology services in accordance with the most up-to-date evaluation processes and methodologies used around the world.



The Awards

Digit awards outstanding products by selecting a Best Performance and Best Value winner in each comparison test. The winner of the Best Performance Award will be the product that scored the highest in the performance segment of our tests.

This award represents the best performing product in our tests and doesn't factor in any other parameter such as value for money, features, support, etc. The winner of the Best Value Award will be the product that scores the highest in our value for money parameter which is derived



taking into account the ratio of a product's performance and features to its price. The product winning this award offers good performance at a great price.

In Bazaar

The second part of the rating system is used to evaluate individual hardware and software products in the Bazaar section. The evaluation covers parameters such as performance, ease of use, value for money and the build quality/features of the product in question and then arrives at an overall rating.

Here each of these parameters is given a weightage of 25 per cent and is rated on a scale of 5, which is represented by arrows (▶).

The greater the number of arrows, the better the product. This simple five-point rating system is designed to give you an easy-to-interpret assessment of a product. For example, a product that receives an overall score of five arrows signifies an outstanding buy!

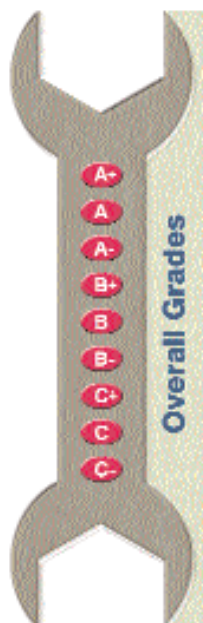
Comparison Tests

We use a dual rating system, the first of which is applied to the Comparison Tests in which we compare the performance of products within a particular category.

Each product is evaluated under different parameters such as performance, value for money, features, warranty and support, etc.

Weightages are then applied to the various test parameters according to their importance for that particular category of products.

These weightages are then used to arrive at an overall grade for each individual product. An overall grade of A+, therefore, indicates that the product is close to perfection.



The 5-point Rating System used in Bazaar

▶▶▶▶▶	Excellent: a brilliant combination of price, performance and features—far beyond expectations
▶▶▶▶▶	Good: a good buy, better than most products in its category
▶▶▶▶▶	Average: reasonably competent but nothing spectacular about the product
▶▶▶▶▶	Mediocre: does not live up to expectations, needs improvement in many areas
▶▶▶▶▶	Poor: has serious drawbacks and needs improvement before it can be used for its target application